Newspapers by ancestry
https://www.newspapers.com/image/628792156

Downloaded on Jul 8, 2020



The Charlotte Observer

THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 1998 Page 8E

Living

Today in Garden

A few tasks in the garden this month will get you ahead before spring.
Garden/ Page 1E

Inside

TV 4E
Movies 5E
Comics 6-7E

Elvis, on video, will front live production by his old band mates/page 5E

VOICES

Spice Girls' power talk is sounding the right note

EDITOR'S NOTE: *Ginger Sigmon Fox is a staffer for The Observer's Iredell Neighbors section, where this column originally appeared.*

By GINGER SIGMON FOX

Two weeks ago, the Pope was in Cuba and President Clinton was in trouble with a new sex scandal dominating the news.

But to my teeny-bopper daughter (and thousands like her across the country), these events hardly earned her interest like the Jan. 23 debut of the Spice Girls movie, "Spice World."

Fox

If you have an adolescent, you probably know the Spice Girls by now — the five young British women who wear snazzy clothes and sing of love and friendship.

Ginger, Sporty, Baby, Posh and Scary wear outlandish platform shoes and hairstyles to match. When their music videos debuted on TV and the singers talked about their philosophy of "Girl Power," they made a strong connection with my 12-year-old daughter, McKenna ... and me.

The heavily English-accented fivesome take every chance — talk shows, music-award ceremonies and public appearances — to talk about how they believe young girls should be able to accomplish their dreams. They say that's what "Girl Power" is all about — young women finding the strength to succeed.

Over the past few months, McKenna has bought dozens of magazines with pull-out posters of the "girls," immediately tearing out the pages to tack them on her walls.

She's bought two books written by the group (I could be cruel here, but I won't) and purchased platform shoes, outrageous hair accessories, blue, green, purple and pink fingernail polish and clothes that resemble the ones I used to wear in the '70s.

At the "Spice World" debut, dozens of young girls with short skirts, big shoes and pigtails (Baby Spice's favorite hairstyle) stood in line for tickets. I looked around at the other mothers (and more than a dozen fathers) in line and wondered if we looked like our parents who waited in line for concert tickets to the Monkees in the '60s.

During the movie, no girls budged from their seats to get popcorn, go to the bathroom or touch up their lip gloss.

McKenna has already been back to see the movie again, and I've been to Toys "R" Us hoping to find the coveted Spice Girls dolls. I found two, Sporty and Baby. Although cleavage, thighs and midriffs are clearly visible on the dolls, who cares. It's no worse than the standard plastic buxom doll.

I actually like the Spice Girls. On the back of each Spice Girl doll box, the women answer questions like "What is Girl Power?" and what is your "Best Advice?"

Sporty answers, "Girl Power is about being able to do things just as well as the boys . . ." And Baby answers, "It's about respecting yourself and others."

But what I like most about this group, even with all their pierced body parts, wild hair, shoes, clothes, tattoos and their ability to attract my daughter's attention at the exclusion of most other things, is this quote from Baby: "Your Mum is your best friend."

The only thing I can add to that is: "Dads are, too."

We want first-person stories about your experiences and what you learned from them. Mail columns (about 400 words) to Voices, Features, The Charlotte Observer, P.O. Box 30308, Charlotte, NC 28230-0308. Fax: 358-5258. Include your mailing address.

SUGAR RAY

With young music fans constantly chasing after the new these days, bands like Sugar Ray can be quickly relegated to one-hit wonder status.

Hear today, gone tomorrow

ALEX BAILEY/Far Girls Ltd.

SPICE GIRLS

Their second album stiffed, their movie was panned, they're being booed at appearances. Some might say the Spice Girls' roller coaster ride to fame is already over.

The music biz is in a tizzy: Why don't young listeners have any band loyalty?

Republic/Universal Records

CHUMBAWAMBA

Chumbawamba finally scored a hit with "Tubthumping." But don't be surprised if your fickle 14-year-old has forgotten the band's name by this time next year.

MARK SELIGER/DGC Records

HOLE

It's been almost four years since Hole's last album. Do fans still remember Courtney Love and company, and will they care about the band's new release?

By NEIL STRAUSS
New York Times

ENCINO, Calif. — At the sleepy Tower Records in the valley here, Andrea Stover, 13, was combing the aisles for CDs with her mother and her younger sister. In her hands, she had debut CDs by rhythm-and-blues singer Usher and the pint-size pop siblings Hanson. Asked whether she would buy follow-up albums by these artists, Andrea responded, "Why would I get the same group again?"

Her mother, Amy, 42, shook her head in disbelief. "It's crazy," she said. "When I was young, I had to have every Grateful Dead album. I have a great record collection, but they just keep barreling through new stuff. They'll listen to a group all the time and then I'll never hear from them again."

A new generation gap is opening up among rock and pop fans. The difference isn't necessarily in the kind of music baby boomers and their children listen to. After all, Oasis emulates the Beatles, Hanson tries to be the Jackson Five, and members of Pearl Jam are avowed fans of the Who and Led Zeppelin.

What's different is the way they consume that music: the elders stood by their favorite bands while the young constantly chase after the new.

Record industry executives say pop music, particularly rock, is changing from a genre that gave rise to career artists (the Beatles, the Rolling Stones, Bob Dylan, Michael Jackson) to one supported by a succession of young, transient acts.

And in the concert industry, which earns most of its revenue from baby-boomer bands, executives are beginning to panic because most of these younger acts are not building a loyal fan base and their ticket sales are languishing compared with the success of their albums.

As comedian Chris Rock said about the pop scene when he hosted the MTV Video Music Awards, "Here today, gone today."

Etty Lewenschuss, 15, another shopper at Tower who was buying her first and, most likely, only CDs by the Ben Folds Five, the Aquabats and Ani DiFranco, said: "I'd rather get a new band than one I've already heard.

Please see **SHOPPING/** *page* **3E**

Sites for and about African Americans

The Washington Post

As the internet grows, it increasingly fosters networks of like-minded people, whether for practical ends like commerce or for broader goals such as building political communities. An array of World Wide Web sites tries to help African Americans on both levels — from employment to culture and literature.

The Big Picture: One place to start is EverythingBlack (**www.everythingblack.com**), a sort of mega-mall home page. It displays 12 broad categories — from arts and humanities to business, entertainment and travel — that offer links to hundreds of Web sites, including African American community news outlets all over the country.

There are numerous specialized sites, too. Mosaicbooks.com/The Black Literary Showcase (**www.mosaicbooks.com**), an affiliate of online bookstore Amazon.com, features summaries and recommendations on current black and Hispanic literature.

Black Facts Online (**www.blackfacts.com**) is a fledgling database/search engine that aspires to be "Your Internet Resource of Black History Information." Black Urban Professionals Online (**www.bupple.com**) provides parenting tips, a resume databank, guidance on personal finance, and professional and social calendars. The Black Collegian Online (**www.black-collegian.com**) offers career advice and a state-by-state job database. And that's just a smattering.

CYBERSPACE

The Last Word: For children, Shelton Jewette, owner of Computers 101, a Washington computer training center, recommends the Afro-Americ Kids Zone (**www.afroam.org/children/children.html**) — which includes fables, games, puzzles and brain teasers.

Pick a card, any card. . .

At this site, you will swear the computer is reading your mind. An online card trick? Impossible! The "Mysterious Rabbit" had me completely fooled. How does it work? I'm not telling.

The Mysterious Rabbit trick is at **pw2.netcom.com/~ulsight/rabbit1.html**.

More Cyberspace *See page* **3E**

Here & Now

Opera alert

Opera Carolina's "Rigoletto" opens at the Blumenthal Performing Arts Center at 8 tonight with additional performances Saturday and Sunday. It's known as being one of the best-loved operas by one of the art form's best-loved creators. Tickets: $12-$52. Details: 372-1000, after 10 a.m.

Wilde thing

Oscar Wilde's very political, scathing comedy "An Ideal Husband" opens at 8 tonight at Theatre Charlotte, 501 Queens Road. Daina Giesler directs a cast including Catherine Smith, Polly Adkins, Mark Farmer and Gay Porter Speer. The show will be performed Thursdays through Sundays until Feb. 21. Tickets: $12 on Thursday evenings and Sunday matinee, $16 on Friday and Saturday evenings. Details: 334-9128, after 10 a.m.

Copyright © 2020 Newspapers.com. All Rights Reserved.

Powered by Newspapers.com